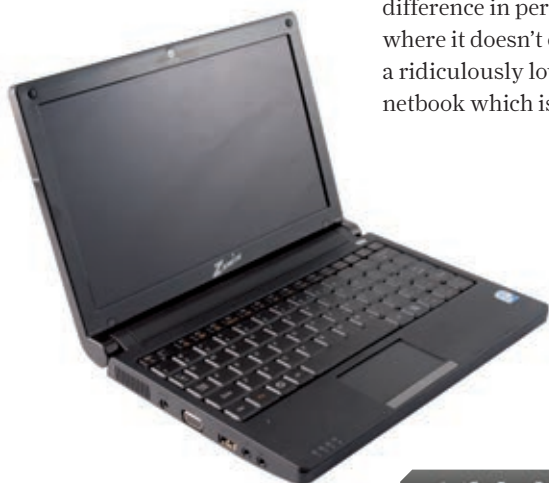


Netbooks

Netbooks have taken over the market. With the promise of low price, excellent battery life and compact size being made, people have received it well. With low price also comes poor quality. We had to test the models in the market to see which was the best model around. They are so popular and there are so many of them, that we tested them two times this past year — once in February and then in September.

Zenith Z-book

The best performer of the year is undoubtedly has been the Zenith Z-book. The Z-book doesn't trail behind the other netbooks by a lot. It uses the Atom N270 processor like the others and even has a similar sized screen as the rest. The difference in performance only shows up in the battery test, where it doesn't come close to the best performers. Still, for a ridiculously low price of Rs. 16,500, you get a very usable netbook which is why we've given it our Zero 1 award.



Best Performer ASUS Eee PC 1005HA

Acer's all new 11.6-inch Aspire One arrives to challenge the ASUS Eee PC 1005HA. We called it in for review and were surprised to find a very good product that's designed well and also built well. We didn't like the older 9-inch Acer Aspire One. That had bad tiny trackpad with oddly positioned buttons along with a really bad keyboard. Looks were the only thing on its side though. This new one has the larger screen, better build and a good elegant design. The performance is a notch up from its older version and a bit up on the last winner — the ASUS EeePC 1005HA in some areas. In general, the ASUS Eee PC 1005HA beats the new Aspire One in the battery test by a big margin. Performance is never going to be a major factor when selecting a netbook, but for those who need the extra oomph, the ASUS EeePC 1005HA is what you need.

